

Busted patterns count. I expected more islands to bust. A bust occurs when price breaks out in one direction and moves no more than 10% before reversing and closing outside the opposite end of the pattern (for a downward breakout, price would close above the pattern's top).

Busted occurrence. There's not a lot of bear market patterns, so let's not discuss those. In most chart pattern types, single busted patterns happen a lot, with no competition from double or triple busts. With islands, that's not the case. In a bull market, downward breakouts, for example, show three or more busts (triple+) as happening most often followed closely by single busts.

Busted and non-busted performance. My usual guidance is to trade single busted patterns if you can find them. However, with islands, the chart pattern is more risky because single busts tend to be rarer than usual and the performance is lacking anyway. I'd look for another pattern type rather than try to trade a busted island.

Trading Tactics

[Table 45.10](#) shows trading tactics. With performance so poor, my main question is, why would you want to trade an island? Are you bored of living? Have too much money and can't give it away? Do you know what I hate? Rhetorical questions.

Let's talk about tactics.